

Betelgeuse
13,415 Suns

Rigel
51,665 Suns

Alnilam
67,480 Suns

KEY DATA

Size ranking 26

Brightest stars Rigel (β)
0.2, Betelgeuse (α) 0.0–1.3

Genitive Orionis

Abbreviation Ori

Highest in sky at 10pm
December–January

Fully visible 79°N–67°S



CHART 6

MAIN STARS

Betelgeuse Alpha (α) Orionis
Variable red supergiant

☀ 0.0–1.3 ↔ 498 light-years

Rigel Beta (β) Orionis
Blue supergiant, usually Orion's brightest star

☀ 0.2 ↔ 860 light-years

Bellatrix Gamma (γ) Orionis.
Blue-white giant

☀ 1.6 ↔ 243 light-years

Mintaka Delta (δ) Orionis
Double star at one end of Orion's Belt

☀ 2.3 ↔ 691 light-years

Alnilam Epsilon (ϵ) Orionis
Blue supergiant; the middle star of Orion's Belt

☀ 1.7 ↔ 1,976 light-years

Alnitak Zeta (ζ) Orionis
Double star at one end of Orion's Belt

☀ 1.7 ↔ 736 light-years

The Trapezium Theta¹ (θ^1) Orionis
Multiple star with six components at the center of M42

☀ 5.1 ↔ 1,600 light-years

Sigma (σ) Orionis
Multiple star with four components

☀ 3.8 ↔ 1,072 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M42 (Orion Nebula)
Bright emission nebula

M78
Reflection nebula

NGC 2169
Open cluster

B33 (Horsehead Nebula)
Dark nebula lying in front of the bright nebula IC 434

NGC 1981
Large, scattered open cluster

Alnitak (ζ Orionis)
The easternmost of the three stars of almost equal brightness that form Orion's Belt; the other two stars are Alnilam in the middle, and Mintaka at the westernmost end

M42
Also known as the Orion Nebula, on a clear night, it can be seen with the naked eye as a hazy patch of light

Rigel (β Orionis)
This blue supergiant is the 7th-brightest star in the sky

